

23rd West Coast Research Symposium on Technology Entrepreneurship

SEPTEMBER 8, 9 AND 10, 2026

The Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity

Banff, Alberta, Canada

Hosted by the Alberta School of Business, University of Alberta

All conference sessions in the Max Bell Building, room MB 252. Opening dinner in KC 101 at the Kinnear Centre.



The Banff Centre for Arts and Creativity. Photo by Don Lee.



UNIVERSITY
OF ALBERTA

UC SANTA BARBARA
UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA



UNIVERSITY OF
OREGON



USC University of
Southern California



UNIVERSITY of
WASHINGTON

WCRS 2026

Tuesday, September 8 | Opening Dinner | KC 101, Kinnear Centre

5:30–7:00 PM | Reception and Dinner | KC 101

7:00–7:30 PM | Keynote: Kathleen M. Eisenhardt, Stanford University | KC 101

Entrepreneur as Preschooler: The Process Perspective on Entrepreneurial Performance

7:30 PM onward | Dessert and conversation | KC 101

WCRS 2026

DAY 1: Wednesday, September 9 | Max Bell 252

Each paper is allotted 20 minutes, followed by 20 minutes of general discussion at the close of the session. Per WCRS convention, all questions and comments are taken at the end.

Presenting authors are shown in bold. Each session closes with a general discussion led by the session facilitator.

7:00–8:45 AM | Breakfast | Vistas

9:00–9:10 AM | Welcome | Max Bell 252

Vern Glaser, University of Alberta

9:10–10:30 AM | Framing the Unthinkable: Visions, Representations and Taboo | Max Bell 252

Facilitator: Mary Tripsas, UC Santa Barbara

Composting the Dead: How Organizations Introduce and Frame Taboo Innovations

Liz Hood, University of Southern California; Tuo Liu, Bess Rouse, Boston College; **Andrew Nelson**, University of Oregon

Animating Meaning: How AI-Generated Representations Reshape Distant Knowledge Recombination and Innovation

Ting Xiao, University of California Santa Barbara

Vision–Reality Gap: Field Coalescence and Bifurcation in the Evolution of Robotics (1962–2005)

Mia Chang-Zunino, ESCP Business School; Stine Grodal, Northeastern University

10:30–10:50 AM | Break

10:50 AM–12:30 PM | After Expertise: Skill, Knowing and Judgment in Technical Work | Max Bell 252

Facilitator: Andrew Nelson, University of Oregon

From Mastery to Procedural Fluency: The Know-How of Fast-Skilling

Dilan Eren, Ivey Business School, Western University

Borrowed Cognition: How AI Exposure Impacts Idea Generation and Evaluation

Mana Heshmati, University of Washington; Cha Li, University of Texas at Austin

Temporal Meta-Uncertainty in Algorithmically Mediated Organizations: How Heterogeneous Forecasting Infrastructures Transform Judgment Under Uncertainty

Natasha Overmeyer, University of Oregon

The Public Trajectory of Vibe Coding: How a Theory of Work Becomes a Regime of Knowing

Vern Glaser, Jennifer Kotadia, University of Alberta

12:30–1:45 PM | Lunch | Vistas

WCRS 2026

DAY 1 Continued: Wednesday, September 9 | Max Bell 252

1:45–3:05 PM | Claims, Disclosures and Names: The Language of Resource Acquisition | Max Bell 252

Facilitator: Michael Lounsbury, University of Alberta

Writing the Playbook: The Codification and Transformation of Entrepreneurial Claims on Kickstarter

Jean-François Soublière, HEC Montréal; Joel Gehman, George Washington University

Market Responses to AI Statements in Creative Domains

Ming zhu Wang, Mana Heshmati, University of Washington

New Venture Name Selection and Capital Acquisition in Late Imperial Russia, 1861–1913

Chad Carlos, Brigham Young University; Olga Khessina, University of Illinois; Samira Reis, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid

3:05–3:35 PM | Break

3:35–4:55 PM | Gendered Evaluation and Entrepreneurial Entry | Max Bell 252

Facilitator: Christine Beckman, UC Santa Barbara

Lost Science or Lost Scientists? Gender and the 2025 NIH Grant Terminations

Daphné Baldassari, University of Southern California; Andy Back, Hong Kong University; Nicola Lacetera, University of Bologna

Gendered Discount in Distant Search Among Early-Stage Entrepreneurs

Jamie Song, ESMT Berlin; Yonghoon Lee, Texas A&M University

Generative AI and Entrepreneurial Entry

Bowen Lou, University of Southern California; Jiayi Bao, Texas A&M University; Hongshen Sun, Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Evening | Dinner on own in the town of Banff

WCRS 2026

DAY 2: Thursday, September 10 | Max Bell 252

Presenting authors are shown in bold. Each session closes with a general discussion led by the session facilitator.

7:00–8:45 AM | Breakfast | Vistas

**9:00–10:20 AM | Building on Ground You Don't Own: Infrastructure and Institutional Limits
| Max Bell 252**

Facilitator: Vern Glaser, University of Alberta

Plug and Pray: Leveraging Data and Algorithms to Organize with the Cloud

Alan Zhang, Columbia Business School; **Wanda Orlikowski**, Massachusetts Institute of Technology

When Growth Outpaces Sustainability: Infrastructure Constraints in AI-Driven Data Center Expansion

Angela Ryu, Shon Hiatt, University of Southern California

Crowdfunding and Transformational Entrepreneurship: Evidence from a Cross-Country Quasi-Experiment

Sandy Yu, University of Minnesota; **Yi Ding**, Warwick Business School; **Jin Chen**, University of Nottingham Ningbo China; **Jason Chan**, University of Minnesota

10:20–10:50 AM | Break

**10:50 AM–12:10 PM | The Costs of Endurance: Backlash, Obligation and Survival | Max Bell
252**

Facilitator: Emily Cox Pahnke, University of Washington

**Survival is Triumph Enough: The Rhythmic Resilience Process of Entrepreneurs in Chronic Adversity
Compounded by Acute Shocks**

Ramzi Fathallah, University of Ottawa; **Trenton Williams**, BYU-Marriott School of Business; **Jay Joseph**, American University of Beirut

On the Basis of Sacred Bonds: Sacred Social Capital and Entrepreneurial Renewal Following the Financial Crisis

Andrew Foley, New York University (Stern); **Derek Lief**, Fordham University; **Tobias Bruegger**, Copenhagen Business School

From Digital Entrepreneurs to Digital Activists: Dynamics and Counter-Dynamics in a Case of Imposed Activism

Sara Mahabadi, Jennifer Jennings, University of Alberta

12:10–12:20 PM | Closing Remarks | Max Bell 252

Vern Glaser, University of Alberta

12:20–1:30 PM | Lunch | Vistas

The conference concludes following lunch.

WCRS 2026

Authors in Attendance

Daphné Baldassari University of Southern California	Mana Heshmati University of Washington	Jamie Song ESMT Berlin
Chad Carlos Brigham Young University	Liz Hood University of Southern California	Jean-François Soublière HEC Montréal
Mia Chang-Zunino ESCP Business School	Bowen Lou University of Southern California	Ming zhu Wang University of Washington
Dilan Eren Ivey Business School, Western University	Sara Mahabadi University of Alberta	Trenton Williams Brigham Young University
Ramzi Fathallah University of Ottawa	Andrew Nelson University of Oregon	Ting Xiao University of California Santa Barbara
Andrew Foley New York University	Natasha Overmeyer University of Oregon	Sandy Yu University of Minnesota
Vern Glaser University of Alberta	Angela Ryu University of Southern California	Alan Zhang Columbia Business School

Additional authors in attendance: TBD

To access full papers: thewcrs.wordpress.com/papers-2/ Password: wcrs2026

About the Host

Alberta School of Business, University of Alberta

Department of Strategy, Entrepreneurship and Management

The Department of Strategy, Entrepreneurship and Management brings together scholars working on organization theory, strategy, entrepreneurship and innovation. The department's research spans institutional and cultural approaches to organizing, the role of algorithms and artificial intelligence in organizational life, and the strategies of new and established ventures.

Alberta Business Family Institute

The Alberta Business Family Institute supports family enterprise in Alberta through research, education and outreach, connecting academic work on family business with the practitioners and families who build and sustain these firms.

WCRS 2026

Walking Routes from the Banff Centre

All routes below begin on foot from the Banff Centre grounds. Sessions begin at 9:00 AM on Wednesday and Thursday, with breakfast at Vistas from 7:00 AM, so there is time before the day starts.

[Banff Centre Maps and Directions webpage.](#)

Route	Out and back	Notes
Campus trails	20–30 minutes	The paths through the grounds. Flat and easy.
Surprise Corner viewpoint	30–40 minutes	Down from the Centre to the lookout over the Bow Valley and back.
Bow River and Bow Falls	45–60 minutes	Continue down to the river and walk it.
Into the town of Banff	35–45 minutes	Downhill out, uphill back.

September is elk rut. Elk are common on and around the grounds and can be aggressive in the fall. Keep well back, never come between a bull and the herd, and give them the trail.

Dress in layers. Banff sits at roughly 1,400 metres. September mornings can be near freezing and afternoons warm.